AspireX | User Personas

Intelligent Career Readiness & Skills Gap Analysis Platform

Purpose: Describe representative users, their goals, challenges and expected interactions with AspireX to inform requirements, user stories, prototype design and acceptance criteria.

Persona 01 — Nethmi Perera

Persona type	Third-year IT undergraduate (primary user)
Age (illustrative)	23
Primary career goal	Junior Business Analyst
Current skills (assumed)	Excel, basic SQL, communication
Current approach	Searches job advertisements and course videos independently; keeps an informal skills list.

Pain points

- Unclear which BA skills employers commonly request.
- Cannot easily compare current skills with a chosen role.
- Finds it difficult to prioritize learning activities.

Needs and expectations

- Choose a target career and enter current skills.
- See a transparent skill-gap breakdown and sample readiness indicator.
- Receive relevant learning suggestions and track progress.

Example AspireX user journey

Create profile → Select Business Analyst → Enter skills → Review skill gaps → Choose learning actions

Illustrative user stories

- As a student, I want to compare my skills with a selected career profile so that I can identify what to learn next.
- As a student, I want to see why a skill is marked missing so that I can trust the assessment.

Persona 02 — Dinuka Fernando

Persona type	Recent computing graduate (primary user)
Age (illustrative)	24
Primary career goal	Entry-level Data Analyst
Current skills (assumed)	Python basics, SQL, spreadsheets
Current approach	Reviews multiple job descriptions and tracks applications and learning in separate notes.

Pain points

- Different job advertisements list different skill requirements.
- Has difficulty deciding which missing skills to learn first.
- Cannot see learning progress in one place.

Needs and expectations

- View a consistent sample role-skill profile with its assumptions.
- Get prioritized skill-gap recommendations and accessible learning links.
- Update skill proficiency and monitor progress over time.

Example AspireX user journey

Create profile → Select Data Analyst → Self-assess skills → View readiness summary → Track learning progress

Illustrative user stories

- As a graduate, I want to identify my highest-priority skill gaps so that I can focus my preparation.
- As a graduate, I want to update my skills after learning so that I can review changes in my readiness.

BA implications and validation

- Functional priorities: profile and skills entry; career selection; transparent gap calculation; learning recommendations; progress updates.
- Non-functional priorities: clear explanations, accessible navigation, privacy controls and reliable handling of sample data.
- Reporting consideration: aggregated, non-identifying sample data may be used in a separate Power BI dashboard for career guidance analysis.
- Validation needed: interview or survey real students and graduates before treating these assumed needs as verified requirements.

Research and ethics note

Both personas, names, ages, behaviors and needs are fictional and assumption-based. They are not real interview participants. No real personal or sensitive student records are included. Career requirements and readiness scores should be labeled illustrative until validated.